

UN SOO KIM

MD & CEO, Hyundai Motor India

Q. Do you see the SUV trend continuing in India? What's next for Hyundai in India in that respect?

Our passion and commitment to deliver the most exclusive products for customers has led to Hyundai becoming India's most preferred SUV brand for two years in succession. With the addition of Alcazar to our line-up, Hyundai now has five stellar brands across a spectrum of diverse choices for customer delight. Our most loved brands Creta and Venue have continued to delight new age customers, offering them experiences that go beyond the realms of mobility. In fact, Venue has also played a key role in Hyundai's SUV success story. In 2021 alone, Hyundai Venue recorded sales of over 1.08 lakh units, demonstrating strong customer love for India's first fully connected SUV. We have a range of five SUVs, and going forward, we will continue to deliver exciting new products with focus on Intelligent Technology, Innovation and Sustainability.

Q. What are Hyundai's plans for EVs?

Hyundai aims to drive the adoption of EVs in India and will expand its range of electric vehicles with a wide variety of body types, including sedans, CUVs (cross-over utility vehicles) and SUVs. The company plans to expand its EV line-up to six battery electric vehicles by 2028, which includes the Kona electric SUV.

VENKATRAM MAMILLAPALLE

Country CEO & managing director, Renault India Operations

Q. Do you see the SUV trend continuing in India? What's next for Renault in India in that respect?

The SUV segment has shown promising results over the past few years because of the greater acceptability and the overall viability that SUVs offer customers, with great affordability. The demand for SUVs continues to increase. In line with our strategy for India, we entered the B-segment with the launch of the Kiger last year. With the Kiger, Renault has successfully launched yet another breakthrough product, targeted at the core of India's automotive market. The Kiger is the third global car from Renault Group that was first launched in India, clearly highlighting India's importance in Renault's global growth plans. The Kiger's success put India among Renault's top five global markets in 2021. Within just a year of its launch, the Kiger has emerged as a volume driver for Renault in India, alongside the Kwid and the Triber.



We are seeing good demand for all our products, and in the coming months our focus will be to meet this demand, amidst the semi-conductor challenges. The SUV segment is the most promising and Renault has a strong focus on this segment.

Q. What are Renault's plans for EVs in India?

Globally, we have a strong focus on EVs. For India, developing a complete ecosystem is important. The right time will be when there is enough localisation to enable us to be competitive. Rather than launching a niche product, our aim is to launch an affordable product for the mass market, thereby addressing the real objective and vision of India's transition to EVs.

MYUNG-SIK SOHN

Chief sales officer, Kia India

Q. Kia's success in India can be solely attributed to SUVs. What's next for the company?

We received an overwhelming response for the four products we launched in the Indian market. Our strength lies in our robust R&D and product planning, and we work hard to identify the unmet needs of Indian customers. We will continue to strengthen our position as a premium mobility brand by bringing in strategic product interventions in the future.



Q. What are Kia's plans for EVs?

Kia has announced that it will bring 11 EVs to the global market by 2026. With respect to India, we believe that there is a tremendous opportunity. The government continues to play a strategic role in India's EV run, intending to make India a formidable force in EV manufacturing and developing charging infrastructure across the country. At Kia, we are working on developing products aligned with our global vision.